

These signify to the browser that this is a PHP file. We will first add the e-mail address to which you need to mail the form file. To specify the e-mail address, type exactly as it is given below:

```
$mailto='varun_dubey@thinkdigit.com';
```

Obviously, here you can put whatever e-mail address you want and all the data in the form we created above will be sent to that address as an e-mail. We will now set the subject line of the e-mail so you can identify where the mail has come from and set appropriate filters if you wish.

```
$subject = "Feedback Form";
```

Whatever you put in place of the Feedback Form will appear as the subject line in the e-mail you receive from the Web site.

Now we need to link the HTML form we created earlier to this PHP-based form. We need to give the path and tell the PHP file where the form is stored. To do so, enter the following line of code:

```
$formurl = "http://www.nutswork.net/feedback.html";
```

The URL here must be absolute and not relative.



The Error And Thank You Pages

Suppose your users do something wrong or there is a server error, they will then see a page of garbled code and to prevent that, you will need to incorporate an error page. This will be a separate Web page with content showing that an error has occurred. This can be used effectively to ensure that the mandatory fields have been filled.

Include the following code:

```
$errorurl =
```

```
"http://www.nutswork.net/incomplete.html";
```

And for the 'Thank You' page once the form has been successfully submitted, you need to add:

```
$thankyouurl =
```

```
"http://www.nutswork.net/thankyou.html";
```

Both the incomplete.html and thankyou.html must reside at the paths mentioned in the file, or the Web visitor will get an error even if he does everything right!



Writing The Code For Sending The Form

```
$name = $_POST['name'];  
//takes the name. Instead of "name" in
```

```
// enter what ever name you gave to  
the NAME: field in the HTML form.  
$email = $_POST['email'];  
$comments = $_POST['comments'];  
$http_referrer = getenv(  
"HTTP_REFERER" );  
if (!isset($_POST['email'])) { header(  
"Location: $formurl"); exit ; }  
if (empty($name) || empty($email)  
|| empty($comments)) { header(  
"Location: $errorurl"); exit ; }
```



The format in which the content is received in the e-mail

The code above makes the fields 'Name', 'E-mail' and 'Comments' mandatory. If the user forgets to enter these, he will be asked to go back and fill the form correctly. To remove or add any more fields, add them by keeping the shown format in mind.

```
if (get_magic_quotes_gpc()) {  
    $comments = stripslashes(  
$comments ); }  
$messageproper =  
"This message was sent from:\n" .  
    "$http_referrer\n" .  
    "----- COMMENTS -----  
    \n\n" .  
    $comments .  
    "\n\n-----  
    \n";
```

The code above is the formatting of the data as it will appear in the e-mail you will receive. '\n' signifies a new line and anything you'd like to add can be entered between double quotes.

```
mail($mailto, $subject,  
$messageproper, "From: \"$name\"  
<$email>\nReply-To: \"$name\"  
<$email>\nX-Mailer: chfeedback.php  
2.02" );  
header( "Location: $thankyouurl" );  
exit ;
```

The above few lines are the instructions for the mail programs (server-based, not Outlook) to put the appropriate information in the right fields so that e-mail address is not shown instead of the name and also vice-versa.

'?>' signifies the end of the PHP file. That's all you need to do! Just save and upload the file and send your first Web-based form!

The Advantages

The benefits of having a such a form are many. As mentioned earlier, you can create it to allow people to get in touch with you instantly without messing around with mail clients or the more tedious Web-based e-mail accounts.

The best part is that you can create multiple forms by just changing the title of the input field and the address you would like it to be mailed to.

Say you have a Web site wherein you would like people to get in touch with you, send you feedback, or report any dead links or errors in your content. You can simply set up the requisite number of forms and change the title of the boxes as required.

We'd advise you to enter different e-mail addresses for each form. So, when you receive the mail, it is organised neatly in terms of content, or if different people handle different aspects such as feedback from visitors or delivery of products, the appropriate e-mail address can be given.

To slightly modify the settings—for instance, if you'd like to conduct a survey and want the results to be mailed to you—simply create a form with more fields than we've done here, and once the visitor is done with it, it will be mailed to you automatically.

If you want a more innovative implementation, you could use the form to take Web-based orders. Before you jump with delight, understand that it is not a replacement to online shopping, but an extension of it can be implemented so your customers can contact you directly and you can service them as soon as you get the e-mail.

Now, you may think, what about spam? Rest assured—there is no cause for concern. To avoid spam, include a mandatory field for telephone numbers which will let you check the authenticity of the mail and you can promptly go about servicing your customers.

The implementations can be many and we're sure you can think of many more original and myriad uses for this PHP form.

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